How to Play

Printable leaflet - two pages. Print this file directly (browser print or any Markdown-to-PDF tool), or read it on screen. Replaces the old `leaflet-how-to-play-A4-portrait.svg` / `leaflet-how-to-play-2-A4-portrait.svg` pair - same wording, plain text instead of hand-laid SVG.

Seven weeks. Thirty-five days. One project standing between your team and the deadline - your team commits five days at a time, resolves them all at once, then closes the week and moves on. From week 2, Events crash into the week you already committed to - spend Adaptability to re-plan around them or cancel them outright. Deliver every Feature before Week 7 closes to win the project - but hit a Team Score above the upper line (5 for every character you started with, plus 64) and you didn't just finish it, you built a team that could survive doing it again: Sustainable High Performance.

Setting up

About fifteen minutes, and the first part is the best part.

1. Deal each player five habitus parts at random and **assemble the figure** onto the Specimen

board.

1. Take the matching **NEED** tile (your VALUES) and **HERO** tile (your PRESSURE RESPONSE), and slot those

too.

1. Turn over board **THE ZONE**. Mark one square on the **SKILLS** grid on your own person board:

where your Head's row meets your Item's column.

1. Read what **Learn**/**Teach** do in one line each - no detail needed yet.
2. Pick one **PROJECT** card. Turn **THE PROJECT** face up and seat it - it names features A-F.
3. Read the project and its six features together - complexity, LOCK tiles across **D** and

F, what unlocks what.

1. Go through the **Activity cards** that come out now: **Work, Engagement, Celebrate, Workshop, Plan**. The

rest wait for later weeks.

Finish the room

- Only **THE PROJECT** and **THE ZONE** start face up. **SHIT HAPPENS** and **THE TEAM** stay

text side up; **THE DEVELOPMENT** stays boxed.

- **Motivation 5** for every character. Week marker on Week 1. Shuffle the Events but don't draw

yet.

- *Everything on the covered boards already sits at 1. It just isn't your problem for a few more

weeks.*

Week 1

Deliberately almost trivial - lay five cards, resolve them, close the week.

*Only **THE PROJECT** and **THE ZONE** are face up. Shit Happens, Adapt and the Ledger wait for week 2; the Specimen panel on your person board isn't read until week 3.*

1 · Plan the week

Lay **five Activity cards** across Monday to Friday. They are the team's cards - nobody plays one. A slot may instead take a **Flex marker**, giving back a day someone worked as Overtime. *Then stop. Nothing has resolved.*

2 · The week runs

Resolve all **five** cards. **Order does not matter** - the week happened at once, not one day at a time.

3 · Close the week

Bank any feature that finished (lift its lock, if any, and pay Capital). Everyone then **loses 1 Motivation** - the weekly grind. Nobody empties out on week 1 alone, so there is nothing else to check yet. *Move the week marker one step closer to the deadline. That's the whole week - three steps, no exceptions.*

bank before the grind - it's the only spend this week.

From week 2

THE TEAM turns face up: **the Ledger** - Trust, Capability, Shared Practice, Standing - starts being read at Close the Week, and your **Need** (the tile on your person board) starts being checked. Adaptability is a shared pile of adapt tokens on Shit Happens. Nothing else about a week changes yet.

A week is five days, and you choose them. That's the entire idea, before anything else gets added to it.

Flip this sheet when Week 1 closes → Week 2 on is on the back

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The same five days, but the table has more to say about them with every week that passes.

The pulse, from week 2 on

The same five steps, every week until week 7 closes.

1 · Plan the week

Lay **five Activity cards** across Monday to Friday - the team's cards, nobody plays one. *Then stop. Nothing has resolved.*

2 · Shit happens

Draw **two Event cards, face up** - and **do not resolve them yet**. They are threats, aimed at the week you already committed. *A day spent on the wrong thing is simply lost.*

3 · Adapt

Spend **adapt tokens** from the shared pool: pay an Event's ADAPT number to cancel it outright.

4 · The week runs

Resolve whatever survived Adapt, then all five cards. **Order does not matter** - the week happened at once.

5 · Close the week

Bank completed features (lift any lock) → **walk the Ledger** coins, at most one step each, and flip any that reached its ring → **Motivation as one net number**: −1 for the grind - every week, ±1 per matching Event category per Torso (check who was hit and who was immune), +1 if the Need was met.

bank first - it lifts locks and tells you whether Celebrate had something to mark.
apply motivation as one number, then check for zero.

Week 2: the Ledger (with Standing and Capital), the Adaptability pool, your Need, and Shit Happens/Adapt, together. The Demo card opens, with Learn, Teach and Reflect. **Week 3:** the Development + the Flex and Overtime part of the Specimen panel. No new cards. **Week 4:** nothing new. **Week 5:** Combos - two named triggers in the same week now pay a small bonus on top of what they already did alone (rulebook §18.1).

How it ends

The project ends when Week 7 closes.

Team Score = (features × 12) + (3 tracks + adapt tokens, max 21) + (Motivation) + (12 × Habits held) − (40 × quits) − (2 × unrepaid Flex) − (5 × tracks that finish at 0 or 1)

If any feature is missing, the Team Score is 0. It never goes below 0.

Two lines: **5 for every character you started with, minus 24** (lower) and **5 for every character, plus 64** (upper).

Outcome	Condition	
Failure	Not everything delivered.	*The score is 0.*
Heroic Success	All six banked, score under the lower line.	*The project made it. The team didn't.*
Sustainable Performance	All six banked, score between the two lines.	*The team held together.*
High Performance	All six banked, score on or over the upper line.	*You built a team as well.*

If you only had thirty-five working days, how would you spend them?